04-14 第一篇

Seed Banks: Saving Plants for the Future

Climate change, disease, and loss of natural habitat are threatening many plant species around the world. Some plants that our grandparents knew may disappear within our lifetime. [1] To protect this precious biodiversity（生物多样性）, scientists have built special vaults—secure storage buildings—where seeds from thousands of plants are kept cool, dry, and safe for many years. These places are called seed banks, and they work like "backup libraries" for the world's plants.

The most famous seed bank is the Svalbard Global Seed Vault in Norway. It is built inside a mountain on a remote island, far from most human activity. [2] The cold Arctic climate and permafrost (永久冻土) keep the seeds frozen even if the power fails. Inside, millions of seed samples from almost every country are stored in sealed boxes. If a crop is lost to disease or disaster, scientists can request seeds from the vault to grow new plants and restore what was lost.

Not all seed banks are as large as Svalbard. Many countries run their own smaller banks to protect local plants. [3] Farmers and researchers can borrow seeds to grow rare varieties, study them, or develop new crops that can survive drought, pests, or changing weather. By sharing seeds, countries work together to ensure that no important plant is lost forever. This cooperation is especially important as the climate becomes warmer and drier in many regions.

Building and maintaining a seed bank takes a lot of work. Seeds must be cleaned, dried, and tested regularly to make sure they are still alive. [4] Some seeds can last for decades or even centuries if stored correctly, but others lose the ability to grow after just a few years. Scientists must check them from time to time and replace old seeds with fresh ones when necessary. This ongoing care keeps the "library" useful for future generations.

[5] From saving ancient crop varieties to preparing for climate change, seed banks offer hope that we can protect the plants that feed us and support our ecosystems. Perhaps one day, a seed saved today will help people grow food in a world very different from our own.

选项

A. In this way, seed banks act as insurance for both food security and scientific research. B. In short, seed banks remind us that the seeds we save today may save us tomorrow. C. These local banks often store seeds that are unique to that area or important for local agriculture. D. The length of time that seeds remain viable（有活力的）

varies widely depending on the species. E. Plants provide us with food, medicine, and the oxygen we breathe—yet we are losing them at an alarming rate. F. Because of its location, the vault stays naturally cold all year round.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] E [2] F [3] C [4] D [5] B

深度解析

- **[1] E**：
  - **线索**：问题背景与引出解决方案。空前提出"Climate change, disease...threatening many plant species...Some plants...may disappear"，空后介绍"To protect this precious biodiversity, scientists have built special vaults"。E选项"Plants provide us with food, medicine, and the oxygen we breathe—yet we are losing them at an alarming rate"（植物为我们提供食物、药物和呼吸所需的氧气——然而我们正在以惊人速度失去它们）中"yet we are losing them at an alarming rate"与空前"threatening...may disappear"呼应，说明保护植物的迫切性，自然引出空后"To protect this precious biodiversity"，衔接顺畅。
- **[2] F**：
  - **线索**：斯瓦尔巴种子库的位置优势。空前介绍"Svalbard Global Seed Vault...built inside a mountain on a remote island"，空后描述"The cold Arctic climate and permafrost keep the seeds frozen even if the power fails"。F选项"Because of its location, the vault stays naturally cold all year round"（因其地理位置，金库全年保持自然低温）中"its location"指代斯瓦尔巴的偏远北极位置，"naturally cold all year round"与空后"cold Arctic climate...permafrost...keep the seeds frozen"完美对应，解释为何选址于此，逻辑紧密。
- **[3] C**：
  - **线索**：各国本土种子库的功能。空前提出"Many countries run their own smaller banks to protect local plants"，空后说明"Farmers and researchers can borrow seeds...grow rare varieties...develop new crops...By sharing seeds"。C选项"These local banks often store seeds that are unique to that area or important for local agriculture"（这些本土银行通常储存该地区特有的或对当地农业重要的种子）中"These local banks"指代各国小型种子库，"unique to that area...local agriculture"与空后"rare varieties...local plants"呼应，自然引出农民与研究者借用种子的用途，衔接自然。
- **[4] D**：

- **线索**：种子保存时长差异。空前提出"Seeds must be cleaned, dried, and tested regularly...still alive"，空后具体说明"Some seeds can last for decades or even centuries...but others lose the ability to grow after just a few years...replace old seeds with fresh ones"。D选项"The length of time that seeds remain viable varies widely depending on the species"（种子保持活力的时间因物种差异很大）中"viable"（有活力的）与空前"still alive"对应，"varies widely depending on the species"总领空后"Some...decades or centuries...others...just a few years"的对比，衔接精准。

- **[5] B**：
  - **线索**：全文收束与升华。空[5]位于结尾段段首，空后列举"saving ancient crop varieties...preparing for climate change"并展望"a seed saved today will help people grow food in a world very different from our own"。B选项"In short, seed banks remind us that the seeds we save today may save us tomorrow"（简言之，种子银行提醒我们：今日保存的种子或许能在明日拯救我们）用"In short"总结全文，"seeds we save today may save us tomorrow"与空后"seed saved today will help people grow food...in a world very different"形成呼应，收束得当。

- **干扰项分析**：
  - **A. In this way, seed banks act as insurance for both food security and scientific research.**：强调种子库的保险作用，易被误填[3]或[5]。但空[3]空前为各国本土种子库的建立，空后为农民研究者借种及国际合作，C的"unique to that area...local agriculture"更直接衔接本土库的内容；空[5]位于全文结尾需总结升华，A的"In this way"通常指代前文具体做法，而空[4]讨论的是种子保存时长与更换，与"insurance for food security"衔接不及B的"seeds we save today may save us tomorrow"自然。属"主题相关但指代与位置不匹配"型干扰。